

Rosalyns Beach Hotel

Technical selection guide for practical devices across POS, display-only operational screens, and back-office administration without turning the document into a pricing sheet.

POS STRATEGY

Use stable 10-inch Android tablets with dependable touch response, solid battery life, and enough RAM for uninterrupted service.

DISPLAY STRATEGY

Treat KDS, BDS, and CDS as fixed browser displays powered by Raspberry Pi kiosk nodes and mounted HDMI monitors.

ADMIN STRATEGY

Use a laptop or desktop-class machine with a larger screen for dashboards, exports, reports, and configuration tasks.

Station	Recommended Form Factor	Operational Fit	Connection Model
POS	10-inch Android tablet with durable case and stand	Large enough for order grids, payments, and quick tap navigation	Dual-band WiFi with offline-tolerant web app workflow
KDS / BDS / CDS	Raspberry Pi 4 mounted behind a fixed HDMI monitor	Better for always-on display duty than repurposed touch tablets	Ethernet preferred in kitchen, WiFi acceptable in lower-risk zones
Admin	15-inch or larger laptop, desktop, or mini PC plus monitor	Comfortable for dashboards, exports, spreadsheet work, and oversight	Stable office WiFi or wired LAN

POS Device Guidance

Choose a practical Android tablet around the 10-inch range with reliable touch performance, adequate RAM, stable browser behaviour, and battery life strong enough for a full shift. Add protective cases, countertop stands, and predictable charging routines so the devices survive daily service conditions and remain cleanly presented at the point of sale.

Why Raspberry Pi Fits KDS, BDS, and CDS

Kitchen, bar, and coffee displays are display endpoints, not transaction devices. A Raspberry Pi 4 can boot straight into Chromium kiosk mode, open the dedicated station URL, and stay locked to that operational screen. This approach is simpler to mount, cleaner to cable, easier to replace, and more sensible for fixed-wall duty than using touch tablets where touch is not the main requirement.

Per-Station Display Build

Each display station should include a Raspberry Pi 4, a dependable power supply, a microSD card, the correct HDMI cable, and a fixed monitor mounted where staff naturally look during service. The Pi should be mounted behind the screen or on the bracket, keeping cables short and reducing accidental interference in fast-moving kitchen or bar spaces.

How the Displays Connect

Each Raspberry Pi joins the hotel network and launches the KDS, BDS, or CDS page in full-screen kiosk mode on boot. Kitchen stations should use Ethernet where possible because heat, metal surfaces, and appliances can interfere with wireless stability. Bar and coffee stations can use strong WiFi if cabling is impractical. A watchdog process can restart the browser automatically if it closes unexpectedly.

Admin Workstation Guidance

Administrative work benefits from a larger screen, full keyboard, and dependable multitasking. A refurbished business laptop or compact desktop workstation is usually more practical than a tablet for finance, inventory, exports, analytics, and configuration tasks. Prioritise SSD storage, dependable connectivity, and enough RAM for multiple dashboards and tabs.

Network and Power Standards

Use dual-band WiFi or managed access points with consistent coverage between POS and service zones. Kitchen displays should be wired wherever possible. For load-shedding resilience, place critical display boards and the network core on small UPS units so the order view remains visible during short power cuts and service continuity is preserved.

Procurement Filters

When sourcing hardware, prioritise durability, local serviceability, screen visibility, mounting practicality, and replacement ease over prestige branding. Avoid underpowered tablets with poor touch response, and avoid treating fixed screens as if they must be tablets. The goal is stable operations, standardised support, and hardware that fits the actual job each station performs.